

Neves **Ana**

Psychology PhD Researcher

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Doctoral Tutor and PhD researcher in Psychology at the University of Sussex, supervised by Dr Dominique Makowski. My research explores the role of interoception - our perception of internal bodily states - in shaping emotional experiences and beliefs about reality. I use a combination of behavioural tasks and physiological measures to investigate how bodily awareness influences responses to emotionally evocative stimuli.

Education

Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) - Psychology — *UK*

University of Sussex — *2024 -*

- supervised by Dr. Dominique Makowski

Research Masters (MRes) in Psychological Methods — *UK*

Univeristy of Sussex — *2023 - 2024*

Bachelor of Science (BSc) - Psychology with Cognitive Science — *UK*

University of Sussex — *2018 - 2022*

Experience

Teaching

Doctoral Tutor for Analysing Data — *Brighton, UK*

University of Sussex — *Jan-Apr, 2026*

- Provided tutorial support for first-year undergraduate psychology students in R programming, data wrangling, data visualisation, and statistical analysis (correlations, t-tests, chi-squared tests, and linear regression).

Doctoral Tutor for Quantitative and Qualitative Methods — *Brighton, UK*

University of Sussex — *Jan-Apr, 2025*

- Facilitated students' critical engagement with quantitative and qualitative research methods in psychology, with a particular focus on measurement issues and the interpretive decisions researchers make when investigating complex psychological constructs.

Doctoral Tutor for Discovering Statistics — *Brighton, UK*

University of Sussex — *Sep-Dec, 2024/2025*

- Supported students in developing both theoretical understanding and practical skills in implementing, interpreting, and reporting statistical analyses, with a focus on the linear model.

Skills

Language

- **Portuguese**: Native
- **English**: Fluent

Research

My PhD investigates how awareness that a stimulus is 'fake' influences emotional and belief-related responses, and seeks to identify the factors that shape these reality judgments. A key focus is the role of interoception in modulating affective responses - measured in terms of intensity, valence, and eroticism. We are also keen on exploring the use of transcutaneous vagus nerve stimulation (tVNS) to manipulate interoceptive sensitivity, with the aim of determining whether such modulation affects both physiological and subjective responses to stimuli labelled as 'fake', as well as their perceived realism.

Techniques, Methods and Open Science

I am currently developing technical expertise in EEG, physiological signal processing, and computational methods including Bayesian modelling. Aligned with my supervisor's (**GitHub**) commitment to open science, I actively contribute to open-source communities (e.g., on **GitHub**) to support accessibility and transparency in research.

I am committed to the highest standards of open and reproducible science, routinely sharing data, materials, and analysis scripts. This commitment is grounded in a strong emphasis on methodological rigour and ethical responsibility throughout the research process.

Publications

Makowski, D., Te, A. S., **Neves, A.**, Kirk, S., Liang, N. Z., Mavros, P., & Chen, S. A. (2025). Too beautiful to be fake: Attractive faces are less likely to be judged as artificially generated. *Acta Psychologica*, 252, 104670.

Makowski, D., Te, A. S., **Neves, A.**, & Chen, S. A. (2025). Measuring Depression and Anxiety With 4 Items? Adaptation of the PHQ-4 to Increase Its Sensitivity to Subclinical Variability Open Access. *Collabra: Psychology*, 11(1), 143431.

Pham, T., Johnco, C., **Neves, A.**, Lim, W., Heng, G., Ygnacio, R., & Forbes, M. (2026). A Meta-analysis of Heart Rate Variability (HRV) and Psychopathology: An Investigation Guided by the Hierarchical Taxonomy of Psychopathology (HiTOP) Framework.. *Journal of Psychopathology and Clinical Science*, 135(6), 729–761.

Pre-Prints

Neves, A., Pfaff, M., Scharte, R., Nogueira-Arjona, R., Poerio, L, G., Makowski, D. (2026). Mega-analysis of the Interoceptive Accuracy Scale (IAS) Structure andits Dispositional Correlates

Makowski, D., **Neves, A.**(2026). Testing the Relationship between Phenomenological Control related to Illusion Sensitivity

Makowski, D., **Neves, A.**, Benn, E. L., Bennett, M., & Poerio, G. (2026). The Mint Scale: A Fresh Validation of the Multimodal Interoception Questionnaire and Comparison to the MAIA, BPQ and IAS

Scharte, R. E., Greenwood, K., Romero Sanchiz, P., **Neves, A.**, Makowski, D., & Nogueira-Arjona, R. (2026) Interoception and Substance use: A systematic review and meta-analysis.

Makowski, D., **Neves, A.**, & Field, A. (2025). Introducing the Choice-Confidence (CHOCO) Model for Bimodal Data from Subjective Ratings: Application to the Effect of Attractiveness on Reality Beliefs about AI-Generated Faces

Other

Talks

Neves, A., Viola, M., Sperduti, M., Marini, M., Ansani, A.,Olivera La Rosa .A., Corradi, G., & Makowski, D. (2026). *Do we find AI-Generated content less emotional? The impact of Reality Beliefs on Affective Responses*, 8th European Society for Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience Meeting, June 3-6, Rome, Italy.

Posters

Neves, A., Viola, M., Sperduti, M., Marini, M., Ansani, A.,Olivera La Rosa .A., Corradi, G., & Makowski, D. (2025). *Do We Find AI-Generated Less Emotional? The Impact Of Reality Beliefs On Affective Responses*, 28th Association for the Scientific Study of Consciousness, July 6-9, Heraklion, Crete.

References

Contact in case of inquiry.

- **Dr Dominique Makowski** (PhD supervisor): `d.makowski@sussex.ac.uk`